

Philosophy and education



Philosophers throughout history, particularly in the areas of moral and political philosophy, have often recognized the importance of education. Epistemology, the study of knowledge and its acquisition, has also influenced the development of educational techniques, and some of the most influential educational theorists, including Jean Piaget and John Dewey, have approached the subject from a philosophical angle.

The philosophy of education considers not only the methodology of teaching and learning, but also the purpose of education and what is being

taught. For philosophers from Plato onwards, education was seen as a means of instilling moral values, guiding students in the way they should lead their lives and the sort of society they should live in. This has been the primary ethos of education until comparatively recently, but in the modern world, is it the place of schools and colleges to provide moral education, or should they solely teach skills for working life, enabling students to become productive members of society?